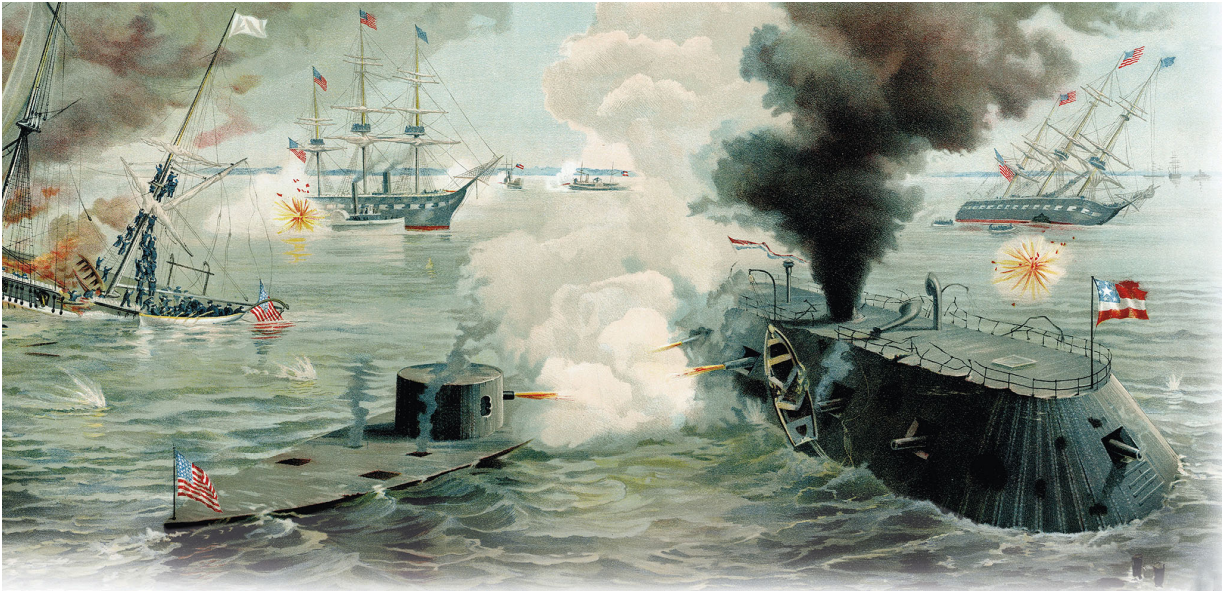




Battle of the ironclads

USS *Monitor* (far left) and CSS *Virginia* (left) exchange fire at close range. The *Virginia* suffered much superficial damage, but neither vessel carried powerful enough armament to have a decisive effect.